

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear “so what for your school” line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, [get in touch](#).

TOP LINE

- NEU's national executive meets today to decide whether to press ahead with the 3 October strike ballot, after ministers offered around £500m in pension-savings funding towards the 2026-27 teacher pay award.

→ **For your school:** Worth watching for the outcome later today — it signals whether autumn disruption is likely.

- A genuinely quiet 24-48 hours otherwise: nothing else new broke overnight across DfE, SEND, Ofsted, safeguarding or funding beyond what's already on your radar.

DATES FOR THE DIARY

24 Sep 2026 — NEU's national executive meets to decide its formal response to the government's pay/funding offer, including whether the 3 October ballot still proceeds.

3 Oct 2026 — NEU's formal strike ballot opens (if not called off), covering 280,000+ teachers; closes 15 Dec.

NATIONAL PAY & FUNDING

- **NEU executive meets today to decide on the strike ballot after a £500m pension-savings offer.**

Education secretary Lucy Powell told NEU general secretary Daniel Kebede that schools can use savings from reduced employer pension contributions — around £500m nationally — to help fund the 2026-27 pay award, addressing the union's objection that it wasn't fully funded. The executive meets today to decide whether the 3 October ballot still goes ahead. Figure as widely reported; today's outcome wasn't confirmed at time of writing. ([Schools Week](#))

→ **For your school:** Worth confirming with your finance lead once the executive's decision lands — it affects whether disruption is likely this term.

DATA POINT OF THE WEEK

£500m

Extra funding ministers say schools can draw from pension-contribution savings to help fund the 2026-27 teacher pay award, addressing NEU's 'fully funded' objection.

Schools Week, Sept 2026

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. [Explore School+](#)

SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.